

Repent is used 46 xs in 43 verses

The 1st time we see repentance is Adam & Eve clothing themselves with the skin God Provided them.

The 1st time in the NT was in **Matthew 3:1-2** *In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea and saying, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near."*

The 1st message Jesus preached was in **Matt 4:17** *-From that time on Jesus began to preach, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near."*

The 1st message to the NT Church by Peter at Pentecost **Acts 2:38** *Peter replied, "Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit."*

The 1st message Christ gave to the church in **Revelation 2:5** *Consider how far you have fallen! Repent and do the things you did at first. If you do not repent, I will come to you and remove your lampstand from its place.*

The 4 H Club sin in reverse.

Hiding, Hands, Heart, Head

It's been said that two of the hardest words for people to say are "I'm sorry." Can you relate? When have you experienced needing to apologize and dreaded doing it? Or maybe, you have been hurt by someone who won't apologize to you? In this special episode about **Yom Kippur**, the Day of Atonement, host Yael Eckstein explores how those two words relate to the holiest day on the Jewish calendar. Admitting our wrongdoings, committing to making changes, and moving forward is what the Jewish holiday of **Yom Kippur** is all about! **When we do this with sincerity, God always forgives and always has mercy. And those words – "I'm sorry" – have the power to heal relationships and change our future for the better**

It is really uncomfortable to admit that we are or we were wrong, but at the same time saying I'm sorry are two of the most powerful words that we can say. Those words have the ability to heal relationships and change the future for the better. It takes humility to apologize, but what I've learned is that people who are able to humble themselves and admit when they are wrong are the people who are truly great.

I learned that the sign of a truly strong and mature adult is the ability to ask forgiveness from anyone, including a small child. I learned that it was not just the right thing to do, but also the hallmark of a truly great person.

The yearly tradition of asking for forgiveness around the high holidays is a great way to practice humbling ourselves all year long when we know that we are wrong and when we were able to

say those two important words, I'm sorry. We have better relationships. We quit carrying around all the excess baggage and we live happier lives.

Thought that God responds to us as we respond to others and if we want God to forgive us for our mistakes, we have to be willing to forgive other people for their mistakes. Just to clarify, we're not allowed to forgive someone on behalf of another person and we're not required to forgive someone who continues to harm us, but if someone approaches us with the sincere apology, we need to practice forgiveness and grant them. Grace in Leviticus 19:17 we are commanded. You shall not hate your brother in your heart. Instead of harboring hatred and resentment, we need to make every attempt to work things out with those who have hurt us. The Christian Bible speaks to the importance of forgiveness too. In Colossians, Paul taught bear with each other and forgive one another. If any of you has a grievance against someone, forgive as the Lord forgave you. Ultimately forgiving others is a gift we give ourselves not only because God is more forgiving of our own wrongdoings but also because we free ourselves of the emotional pain that comes with hanging on to past hurts and offenses. In fact, forgiving others is considered so important in the Jewish tradition that it is something we are encouraged to practice daily.

There's a beautiful Jewish prayer that many people say every night is part of the prayers we say before going to bed. I say this prayer with my own kids when I put them to sleep and these are the words Master of the universe. I hear by forgive anyone who is angered or antagonized me or who ascend against me, whether against my body, my property, my honor, or against anything of mine, whether he or she did so accidentally willfully, carelessly or purposefully whether through speech deed or thought whether in this lifetime or another life time, I forgive everyone may know person be punished because of me. May it be your will Lord my God and the God of my forefathers that I sin no more and with your abundant mercies, may you erase any sense that I have already committed. May the words of my mouth and the thoughts of my heart find favor before you God, my rock and redeemer. In the first part of the prayer, we declare that we forgive anyone who may have harmed us and in this second part, we ask that God forgive us for anything we may have done. We forgive and seek forgiveness so that we can begin the next day fresh with a clean slate Yom Kippur, the day of atonement takes place just 10 days into the Jewish New Year. The forgiveness that we achieve on this day allows us to start the new year cleansed and clear, refreshed and unburdened. This state of being is best described by the liturgy of the young people service, which describes how the high priest appeared when he emerged from the Holy of Holies the Kodesh after achieving atonement for the nation of Israel. I love this part of the prayer service. The words are so beautiful. The imagery so rich and we sing it joyfully together. The text compares the appearance of the high priest to many images, including a rainbow in the midst of the clouds, a rose in the midst of a garden, a bridegroom who has just been wed a bright star in the dark sky to light that streams in through the window. That glowing spirit is what we are after and what is possible when we forgive and are forgiven and this wonderful state of being is available to us on Yom Kippur more than any other time of year in Isaiah 1:18. God says though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow. Our God is a merciful God who will overlook our wrongdoings and recreate us as though we are brand new and this is the season for receiving this gift of cleansing renewal and complete

forgiveness this week takes some time to think about the role forgiveness complaint in your life. Is there anyone that you need to ask forgiveness from? Can you pick up the phone and make that call? Is there anyone that you have not forgiven yet? In old friend, a family member or maybe even yourself? What would you like God to forgive you for? What are the small blenders or huge mistakes that you'd like to erase from your record? The gift of renewal and fresh start is yours to receive. When you seek forgiveness, give forgiveness and give over your past to god.